

SEPTEMBER

3rd

1918

20¢

PUBLISHED
TWO TIMES A MONTH

Adventure



SEPTEMBER

3rd

1918

20¢

PUBLISHED
TWO TIMES A MONTH

Adventure



The Project Gutenberg eBook of Making Good for Muley

This eBook is for the use of anyone anywhere in the United States and most other parts of the world at no cost and with almost no restrictions whatsoever. You may copy it, give it away or re-use it under the terms of the Project Gutenberg License included with this eBook or online at www.gutenberg.org. If you are not located in the United States, you will have to check the laws of the country where you are located before using this eBook.

Title: Making Good for Muley

Author: W. C. Tuttle

Release date: January 5, 2022 [eBook #67060]

Most recently updated: October 18, 2024

Language: English

Original publication: United States: The Ridgway Company, 1918

Other information and formats: www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/67060

Credits: Roger Frank and Sue Clark

*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK MAKING GOOD
FOR MULEY ***



Making Good for Muley

by W. C. Tuttle

Author of "A Prevaricated Parade," "Loco or Love," etc.

If there's a word of truth in that old saying about beauty being only skin deep, Susie Abernathy was the thinnest-skinned person I ever saw. I may not be a judge of womanly beauty, and the poetry of my soul may have been shook loose by pitching broncos, and buried deep under a coating of alkali dust, but I sure do sabe when a woman is hard to look at.

Seems to me like it's human nature for a feller with squirrel-teeth, no jaw to speak about and a physique like a corn cultivator to marry a beautiful female, and vice versa—not that "Muley" Bowles qualifies in the beauty division, but at that I reckon he shaded Susie a little.

Muley was a poetical puncher, of considerable avoirdupois, and he found Susie a thing of beauty and a joy forever. Susie was a niece of Zeb Abernathy, who owned a sheep outfit on Willow Creek, and a grouch toward all cowmen—and Muley punched cows for the Cross J outfit, and drew forty a month from old man Whittaker.

I'm not belittling Muley's salary, 'cause I drew the same, and so did "Telescope" Tolliver and "Chuck" Warner. Back in the dim and distant past,

when cows first come into style, the old-timers got together and settled the pay of the average cow-hand.

They figured that any normal puncher—if there is such an animal—would try at least three turns of the roulette wheel, at ten dollars per turn. That left him ten dollars. He'd buy some tobacco, some red neckties and perfume, and what was left, at two-bits a drink for hooch, would just carry him a few inches short of the murder and sudden death stage.

I've just been up to the house to draw my stipend from the old man, and am on my way back to the bunk-house, when Muley rides in. He's humped over in his saddle, like Misery going to a cemetery, and if you can stamp despair on a full-sized milk-cheese he had it on his face.

He slips his saddle off, turns his bronc into the corral, leans against the fence and cuts loose the granddaddy of all sighs. There ain't many men that you can hear sigh at pointblank range for a .30-30, but you could with Muley. It was like releasing the air on a freight train.

I wanders down there and passes the time of day with him, but he don't respond. He exhausts deep into his soul once more, and hangs up his saddle.

"Some of your relatives die, Muley?" I asks.

"Hello, Hen," says he, sad-like, "I ain't got no relatives—except one aunt. I don't know whether she's alive or not."

"Name of Bowles?"

"Nope. Name's Allender. Maw's name was Allender, and that's why I was named Lemule Allender, and—what do you want to know for?"

"You sighed a couple of times," I reminds him, and he nods and looks off across the range.

"Henry, how can I make some money? Regular money. I can't get along on forty a month—no more."

"You aim to marry Susie Abernathy?" I asks.

Muley digs a little trench with the toe of his boot, and shakes his head, sad-like—

"No-o-o, I reckon not, Hen."

"Just come from there?" I asks.

"Uh-huh. Listen, Hen: can you keep a secret? I know danged well that you can't, but I got to talk to somebody. Me and Susie's got it all framed up to get married, but she argues that I got to see Zeb. Susie ain't of age yet, and Zeb is her guardian, Sabe?

“Believe me, Henry, if I owned a penitentiary I’d hire Zeb. I’d a killed him a long time ago if it wasn’t for Susie, ’cause no sheep-man can tell me where to head in at—dang his old billy-goat face! He’s a darned——”

“Not to change the subject, Muley,” says I, “but why don’t you ask him?”

“I did. Do you think I’d feel this way over futures? You’re darn well right I asked him! Know what he said? He said to me, just like this: ‘Mister Bowles, you keep away from Miss Abernathy. She’s got her sights set higher than a forty-dollar puncher.’

“That’s what he said, Henry, and then I said: ‘Mister Abernathy, you’re tilting that gun for her: let her do her own shooting,’ and he said, ‘Your reputation ain’t none too good, and if the Vigilantes ever organize here Susie would be a widow.’ ‘You wouldn’t know it,’ says I, ‘’cause they’d get you first.’

“Muley,” says I, “which one of you shot first?”

“Neither one. I beat him on the draw, but you can’t kill your sweetheart’s guardian. It ain’t ethical, Hen. He told me that any old time I could show enough money to buy out his herd I could have Susie. I told him I wasn’t in the habit of buying either sheep or wives, and he said he knowed that without me telling him. Said that no forty-a-month puncher was ever that foolish.”

“How about Susie—does she love you, Muley?”

“Uh-huh,” he sighs, “she sure does. I don’t know how she can, but she does.”

“I don’t know either, Muley, but it takes all kinds of folks to make a world.”

“I been thinking of marriage for a long time,” he sighs, “I been afraid to ask her, but today she up and kissed me, and that settled it, Hen. Funny what a little kiss will do thataway. It makes me desperate.”

“It would have done the same to me, Muley. If a girl like her kissed me I’d likely turn outlaw. You aim to go to Chicago with that train of cows?”

“I can’t, Hen. I hope the old man don’t ask me to. You going?”

“No. Telescope and Chuck are going, but the old man wants me to act as foreman while they’re gone—he’s going, too. I’ll ask him to let you stay, if you want me to, Muley.”

“I’d love you like a brother, Hen,” he sighs, “I want to be near her.”

That's Muley. Being of a poetical temperament he has to confide in folks. If me or Telescope or Chuck got kissed by a lady we'd cherish the memory to our graves—unless it was Susie, and think of it only when alone.

I ain't so bad to look upon, and a lady couldn't be censured for giving me a kiss, but when it comes to Telescope and Chuck—well, I suppose they'll eventually marry beautiful women.

Telescope is built like a bed-slat, and orates openly that he's a twig of the Tolliver tree, which flourished and bought colored help in Kentucky before the plans were drawn for the pyramids. Chuck Warner don't claim nothing, and don't get sore if you subtract from his ancestry. He was born west of the Arizona line, and if he descended from anybody it was Ananias.

Chuck's legs are as short as his memory, and he was born with the face of a horse and the trusting eyes of an angel. He never told the truth but once. A big feller, from down below Mesquite, took him down and bumped his head on the ground.

"You got enough?" asks the big person, and Chuck howls—

"Plenty!"

"You ain't lying, are you?" asks the feller, after he lets Chuck up.

Chuck brushes off his clothes and shakes his sore head:

"No! Dang it all! I wasn't in no position to lie about it!"

Muley told me that I couldn't keep a secret, and I didn't. Me and Chuck and Telescope rides to town that afternoon, to foller out the usual program expected of punchers with a month's pay aboard, and I tells them about Muley's troubles.

"He's more to be censured than pitied," admits Chuck. "I don't blame Zeb, but I do hate a shepherd what thinks a puncher ain't good enough for his relatives."

"Poor Muley," says Telescope, sad-like, "any man what is just one aunt shy of being an orphan has my sympathy. I'll promise you, Hen, that I'll do all I can."

"In Muley's name I thanks you," says I, "but if you can't do it for Muley don't do it on my account. I ain't going to marry her. I just feel sorry for him. I'd feel sorry for anybody what was in love with Susie."

“She ain’t exactly of the vampire type,” agrees Chuck. “Muley’s got one dead immortal cinch though: nobody’s going to come along and steal her away from him.”

“Zeb says he’ll have to marry her over his dead body or bring money enough to buy out his sheep,” says I.

“The latter is the more revolting,” says Telescope. “Tell Muley we’ll fix it for him after we get back if we have to steal Zeb’s sheep so he won’t have nothing to sell.”

The next few days we’re a busy crew, loading twenty cars of beef for Chicago, and we don’t have much time for conversation. Muley is too fat to herd ’em up the chute, so he sets down cross-legged on top of a car, and checks off the loads. Zeb Abernathy comes over to the yards and sets down on top of the fence, along with a lot of other loafers, and when Telescope sees him he crosses the corral and sets down beside Zeb.

“Howdy, Zeb,” says Telescope, rolling a smoke. “You going to leave here after you sells out, or are you going to make your home with Susie and her husband?”

“Hu-u-u-u-h?” grunts Zeb, amazed-like, “what’s that you said?”

“Haw, haw, haw!” laughed Telescope, slapping Zeb on the back. “You can’t keep things like that a secret around here, old-timer. What’ll we bring to the charivari—sheep-shears or tin cans?”

Zeb sets there, working his jaws faster and faster over his tobacco, and pretty soon he looks up at Muley. Muley grins at him, and nods. That’s the last straw.

“Muley’s going to buy out Zeb and marry his niece,” slates Telescope to Johnny Myers, owner of the Triangle brand. “Muley’s going to be a sheep-king, Johnny.”

All this time Zeb has been getting off the fence, and he’s so mad that he dances a jig in the dust when he hits the ground.

“Ya-a-a-a-ah!” he whoops, waving his long arms like a swarm of bees was after him. “Telescope Tolliver, you’re a liar if you think it! Marry that fat, forty-dollar fool! Buy my herd! Say, he ain’t never had money enough to buy a wool sock! Ya-a-a-a-ah! You think you’re funny, don’t you?”

“Ya-a-a-a-ah!” mimics Chuck, wiggling his ears. “Zebbie, you’re learning. Now the chorus—ba-a-a-a-a-ah!”

Zeb's feelings can't stand no more, so he turns around like a man with a sore throat, and goes back toward town stiff-legged like a bear with a peeve on.

"Zeb loves you fellers," laughs Johnny. "I heard him say this morning that there's just five things he hates. One is a rattlesnake and the other four draws a salary from Whittaker. What's he sore at you fellers for? Has the sheep affected his brain?"

"Such a theory is absurd, Johnny," says I. "It can't be proved, 'cause nobody with brains ever mixes up with sheep. You can't corrupt a coyote."

A little later on me and Muley are setting on the fence, when Telescope climbs up beside us and talks to Muley like a father.

"You realize what this here marriage stuff means, Muley?" he asks. "You sure you ain't just sick like a calf for it's maw?"

"I know my own heart, liver and lights, Telescope," replies Muley.

"Really love her with all your heart and soul, eh? Say, I'll bet you'd turn her down cold if it was to your advantage."

"You dang well know I wouldn't!"

"Suppose," says Telescope, "suppose somebody said to you: 'Muley, I'll give you a year's salary if you'll keep away from Susie?' What would you do?"

"Me? I'd rise up on my hind legs and inform him that my love ain't for sale. Sabe? Not for the salary of a lifetime."

Telescope thinks it over for a while, and then shakes his head, sad-like:

"Maybe you would, Muley. I sure hopes you gets them sheep, 'cause you qualifies for the shepherd class without no fixing. I've read about love making a fool out of a man, but—well, it ain't no funeral of mine."

That night we shakes hands with Telescope and Chuck and the old man, and wishes them many happy returns of the day.

"Don't give up the ship, Muley," advises Telescope. "Do a lot of thinking while we're gone, and if you can figure out any way of making money without robbing a bank, me and Chuck will put her over for you, eh, Chuck?"

"A stiff upper lip gathers no mustache," proclaims Chuck, "and a faint heart never rustled no sheep, Muley. So-long, you pitch-fork puncher. And, Hen-ree, don't fall in love. One shepherd in the family is a plenty."

Me and Muley rides back to the ranch, but Muley ain't got much to say. Love is a queer little animal, and affects folks different. Muley's was the dark-blue variety, with circles around the eyes.

The next morning after breakfast Muley gets a sheet of paper and a pencil, and seems to compose deep-like. After a while he cuts loose a deep sigh, and looks, dreamy-like, at the ceiling.

"I'm here," says I. "Can I help you in any way, Muley?"

"I've got it," he sighs. "You can't appreciate it, 'cause you ain't got no finer feelings, but I'll recite it to you:

"I loved a darling angel,
And she loved me quite a lot.
Her ears are like the clam shell,
And I can forget her not.
She's doomed to marry money,
And my heart will break, I think,
If I don't wed this angel,
I will drown myself in drink."

"Nice sentiment," I applauded. "Bobby Burns never had nothing on you except the long sound of his r's, but you'll have to put off your demise for at least another month. You can't do an artistic job of drowning in a couple of dollars' worth of hooch. If you was to get in over your depth in liquor, Muley, what brand would you prefer?"

Right then Muley gets sore at me. I finds that you can josh a man about love just so far, and then he turns like a worm and tries to bite me.

For the next few days he writes poetry in the evening, and is absent most all day. He ain't a pleasant critter to talk to, so I spends most of my time playing solitaire. One day down in Paradise I runs across Susie.

"Seen Muley lately?" I asks, and she shakes her head.

"No. Uncle Zeb ordered him off the ranch, and since then I've only seen him at a distance. He—he said he was going to try and convince uncle that he's something more than an ordinary cowboy. Do you think he can, Mister Peck?"

"Not unless uncle loses his sense of sight. Muley is pining away, day by day, and unless something comes up to relieve the situation he'll be able to

go through a door without turning the knob. I know this is a leading question, Miss Abernathy, but would you marry that Lemuel Bowles if you had a good chance?"

"Why—er—uh-huh," says she, nodding her head brave-like, while her ears get hot enough to light a cigaret on.

"I feel sorry for Muley," says I, letting her take it any way she wants to, and then I lopes away, 'cause I sees Zeb coming.

The next morning we ain't no more than out of bed when in rides old Paddy Morse. Paddy runs the post-office, along with his little store, and this is the first time I ever seen him at the Cross J.

"Is Le-mule Allender Bowles to home?" he inquires, peering over his specs at me.

"Right here, Paddy," says Muley. "What do you want?"

"Letter for you. Reckon it's for you, 'cause there ain't no other Bowles around this here neck of the woods. You got to sign your full name, same as on that letter or I can't let you have it. Sabe?"

"This here is a special delivery letter—darn such things! Uncle Sam forces me to ride plumb up here to deliver this or take the consequences, which I believe is three hundred days in jail or a year—sign right on that line. Now, I reckon I'll go on back. Hope it ain't bad news, Muley. Mostly always a letter of that kind or a telegram means death. Come from Milwaukee. You got any kin in Milwaukee?"

But Muley has gone back into the house, and Paddy don't get the information he seeks.

About fifteen minutes later Muley comes down to the bunk-house, where I'm putting some rosettes on a new bridle, and he's got a grin plumb across his fat face. I glances at him and goes on working.

"Henry," says he, after a little while, "would you like to have a job herding my sheep?"

"Your sheep? Sure. I'll herd all you got in my sleep."

"I'm going to be the richest man in Yaller Rock County," he proclaims.

"You better talk lower, Muley," I advises. "If the county commissioners hear you talk thataway they'll way-bill you to the loco-lodge at Warm Springs."

"You remember me telling you about my Aunt Agnes, Hen? She died."

"And left you a sheep?" I asks.

“Sheep—always sheep! Take a look at this.”

He hands me a letter—the one what Paddy brought him, and I looks her over. The brand opines it to be from Milwaukee, and the top of the letter proclaims that Frederick & Quincy are lawyers. She listens something like this:

DEAR SIR:

It grieves us to inform you that your aunt, Miss Agnes Allender, of this city, died on the fifth day of August, 1900.

According to her last will and testament, you, which she designates as her favorite nephew, will inherit the bulk of her estate, which is valued at about one hundred thousand dollars.

As you likely know she was a very eccentric person, and her will imposes you as follows: without receiving a cent of said inheritance you must, before the fifteenth day of August, 1900, have invested four-fifths of said hundred thousand dollars in sheep.

She also designates that: the said Lemuel Allender Bowles must not marry for the space of five years under penalty of forfeiture of entire inheritance. Also that he take a care for Alfred and Amelia for the rest of their natural lives. All of the foregoing requests must be complied with or my estate is to be divided between charitable institutions aforementioned in my will.

On the fifteenth day of August, 1900, our representative will call on you and examine your investments. We wish you luck.

I hands it back to him, and goes on working.

“Well,” says he, sort of choking-like, “don’t I get congratulated?”

“As soon as I gets time I’m going to feel sorry for you, Muley. How in thunder can you invest eighty thousand dollars around here, when everybody knows you ain’t got a cent, and everybody hates sheep. You can’t get married for five years, and you’ve got to feed, water and groom Alfred and Amelia all the rest of their natural lives. Wonder what them twin-sounding things are, Muley?”

Muley sets to thinking it over, and folding and unfolding that letter:

“Since you sympathized with me, things don’t look so rosy,” he admits, with a deep sigh. “Reckon I missed that marrying part. If Alfred and Amelia

got a fair start they ought to be about due. Reckon I'll ride down to Paradise—dang the luck! I've torn that letter plumb in two!"

He puts the two pieces in his vest pocket and goes off down to the corral.

The longer I thinks things over the harder it looks for Muley. Muley ain't got the reputation of a saint around here, and can't even lie so folks will believe him. Zeb owns all the visible supply of sheep, and Muley ain't got no time to spare if he's going to make good.

Along about noon Muley rides in. He's got a big bundle under one arm and a big box under the other. He deposits his plunder on the steps, and sets down. I sets down beside him to wait until he gets through sighing, when all to once a squeaky voice yells:

"Way 'round 'em. Shep! Who's crazy!"

I hops plumb off the steps, and whirls with my gun ready. Muley looks at me, sad-like, and sighs again—

"That's Alfred, Henry."

"Alfred?" I asks. "Alfred who?"

"I don't know. Nobody introduced me, but it don't matter—Alfred is a parrot."

"Oh!" says I, "what's Amelia—a lady bug?"

"Naw-w-w! Cat."

"Scur-r-r-reek! Sheep dip! Sheep dip! Har, har, har! Scur-r-reek!" announces Alfred.

"Hen, what's the natural life of a parrot?" asks Muley, without lifting his head.

"I don't know. Why the question?"

"That letter specifies 'natural lifetime.' That's the joker."

"Did it say that?"

"Sure did. Wait, I'll show you." He fumbles around in his pockets for a while, and then looks foolish-like at me: "The front half of that letter is gone, Henry! Now, where in thunder did I drop that?"

He hunts some more but his pockets don't essay a trace.

"Har, har, har! Way 'round 'em, Shep!" shrieks Alfred, and Muley kicks the cage off the porch.

"Shut up! You cross between a duck and a phonygraph! You ain't yelped nothing but sheep-talk since I got you. No wonder Aunt Agnes died—she

must have had ticks!”

“You ain’t showing proper respect for the dead, Muley,” I reminds him.

“Is that so!” he yelps. “Is that so! Well, dog-gone it, Hen, she didn’t show no respect for the living when she shipped me these trinkets, did she? Sending a puncher a sheep-talking buzzard ain’t showing a whole lot of respect. That cat is so old I’ll have to feed it on a bottle, and—”

“Sheep dip!” screams Alfred. “Who’s crazy?”

Muley throws his coat over the cage, and slams the whole works into the house. He follers it inside, and I sets there for a while thinking things over. The slats on Amelia’s home ain’t none too secure, so I loosens one end, and as I goes inside the bunk-house I sees Amelia trotting off toward the barn.

Muley comes down after a while and sets down on the bunk. “Alfred danged near bit my finger off, and Amelia’s made her getaway, Hen,” he announces in a sad voice. “Amelia was down there on the corral fence, making faces at Chuck’s coyote pup, and she offers fight when I tries to calm her spirits. Aunt Agnes must have been a nut over ferocious animals.”

“Nevertheless she was your mother’s sister, and left you all her wealth,” I chides him.

“Yah! Like throwing both ends of a rope to a drownding man, and forgetting to hang on to the middle. Can’t marry for five—huh!”

He gets up and stomps out of the place, and I opines that Muley’s inheritance is beginning to bear down upon his immortal soul.

The next day Hank Padden, who owns the Seven A outfit, shows up, and sets down with me in the parlor. Muley is washing up, and when Hank asks for him he yells that he’ll be out in a minute.

“I’m going to make Muley an offer,” says Hank to me, confident-like. “I hears that he’s going to get married, and I needs a foreman what is a married man. Sabe? Single men ain’t got nothing to hold ’em down. I like Muley—dang his fat carcass—and I rides over here to see him.”

“Uh-huh,” says I, ’cause there ain’t nothing else to say, and then Hank yells at Muley:

“Come out here, you half-ton puncher! I want to talk to you about——”

“Sheep dip! Sheep dip! Har, har, har!”

I know it’s Alfred, but if it don’t sound like Muley I’ll eat my quirt. Same little wheeze that Muley has in his laugh.

Hank comes to his feet like a shot, and glares at the half-closed door. He puts on his hat, walks straight out of the door, gets on his bronc and fogs away from the Cross J.

I hears a crash in the next room, a couple of shrieks, and out comes Alfred with most of his tail feathers missing. He sails around the room a couple of times, finally hits the open door, and perches on the hitch-rack in front of the house.

Muley comes out, with a shotgun in his hand, and glares around.

“Natural lifetime, Muley,” I informs him, and he tosses the gun on the sofa.

“That bird will be the death of me, Henry!” he wails, “yelping sheep-talk at Hank Padden is like lighting a cigaret with a stick of dynamite. What did he want of me?”

“He came over to sympathize with you about your aunt.”

“Oh!” says Muley, blank-like, looking out of the window. “Ain’t this Wick Smith coming?”

It was Wick. He ties his bronc and comes inside. To hear him talk you’d think that rheumatism had typhoid-pneumonia and bubonic plague beat so far that you could cure ’em both with internal applications of peach pie.

“I got to get away from here,” states Wick, after we discusses the weather a while. “Every season I lives here brings me that much nearer the grave. I want to take a pardner into my store, and while I ain’t decided exactly about it, I comes up here to have a talk with Muley. I needs new blood in my place, and I got to have a married man, which has a little money. Sabe?”

“You got any sheep?” I asks.

Wick sets up straight and glares at me.

“Sheep? I’m a merchant—not a shepherd!”

“Wool is good for rheumatism,” says I, offhand-like, trying to smooth over my mistake.

“If you’re looking for a married man with money you sure got into the wrong pew, Mister Smith,” states Muley.

“Zeb told me that you had an aunt—” begins Wick, wise-like, and then:

“*Squr-r-r-r-reek! Meo-o-o-o-o-ow! Yip, yip, yip!*”

First comes Amelia. She’s traveling so blamed fast that she looks like a string of about six cats. Right behind her comes that coyote pup, digging

deep into his soul for joyful sounds, and behind him, screeching and screaming comes Alfred, and they invade the parlor.

Wick hops to his feet as they enter, and of course he's the highest point in the room. A cat will always hit for elevation—therefore Wick got Amelia. Me and Muley sort of draws back to keep the score, but things happen too fast for computation. Amelia draws all four feet together in Wick's scalp, the same of which makes Wick wrinkle up his face, and forget the rheumatism in his legs. The bird and the coyote don't do much except cut circles until Wick starts, blind-like to leave there, and falls over a chair.

Wick turns over once, lands on his hands and knees, and pilgrims out of the door, with the cat prospecting his dandruff, Alfred hopping up and down on his back, and the coyote pup hanging on to his coattails, and skidding along, making little snappy barks of delight.

They all rolls off the porch, where the three animals tangles up, leaving Wick alone. He forks his bronc in a hurry, and sets there rubbing the haze out of his eyes.

Amelia is setting a new cross-country record for cats, as she hunts for a high spot, and the pup is singing along right behind her.

Alfred walks circles around a post for a few seconds, and then flutters to the top of the hitch-rack. He ruffles up what feathers he's got left, cocks his head on one side and screeches:

“Har, har, har! Sheep dip! Who's crazy?”

“My gosh!” explodes Wick. “That cyclone hit me so hard that I can see green eagles and hear 'em talk!” and he backs his bronc away, cautious-like, and leaves us in a hurry.

Me and Muley looks at each other for a while, and then Muley yawns:

“I must have lost that piece of letter where Zeb could find it. Well, it didn't say nothing about buying sheep, anyway, Hen.”

“Lucky it didn't, Muley. If the community thought you intended to bring eighty thousand dollars' worth of sheep on to this range you'd be the honored guest at a cravat party. Your auntie didn't understand conditions when she wrote that will, Muley.”

“Why emphasize ‘when she wrote that will,’ Henry!” he asks, sad-like. “After looking at Alfred and Amelia—well, Henry, there's a destiny what shapes our ends.”

Next morning at breakfast we're interrupted. Comes a thump of feet outside the door, and a voice yells—

“Hello, the house!”

“Hello the ——!” says I. “That sounds like Zeb Abernathy, Muley.”

Muley steps over and picks up the old man's shotgun.

“Let him in, Henry,” says he. “If he comes on the prod I'll scatter his remains to the four winds.”

I opens the door, and the old pelican bows to me like I was the fourth king in the deck to enter his hand.

“Howdy, Henry,” says he, and then he happens to see Muley with the shotgun. “I comes in sorrow not in anger,” he states, “my soul is filled with contrition.”

“As long as she's filled with something I'll save my buckshot,” opines Muley. “Come on in and rest your ticks, Zeb Abernathy.”

“Nice weather,” observes Zeb, mopping his face with a red handkerchief. “May rain and it may not. I kind of look for a dry spell.”

“The Weather Bureau at Washington gets but annual reports, which reach us too late, so we thanks you for the information,” says Muley.

“I hope I see you both well,” opines Zeb.

“Your eyesight don't worry me none to speak about,” states Muley. “The last time I meets up with you I made you throw your gun down the well. How's your sentiments concerning me at present?”

“I'm filled with meekness and contrition, as I aforementioned, Le-mule. It aches my heart to know that I provoked you thataway, and I pilgrims over here to make amends. Sabe?”

“Why this sudden change of attitude?” inquires Muley, and Zeb sort of squirms in his chair.

“She comes to me like a yelp in the night,” says he, pious-like, “I gets to thinking thusly: ‘Le-mule Allender Bowles, I ain't treated you right. I hops on to you like a coyote on a carcass, and reviles you abusive-like, 'cause you desires to marry into my family. I lets my interest in Susie blind me to her best interests, but now I sheds the scales off my eyes, and comes out into the sunshine of true understanding.”

“The more I thinks about it, Le-mule, the worse I feels. Youth calls to youth, and what is stronger than the call of true love? She ain't never yelped at me, boys, but I'm a heap wise. While Le-mule is only getting forty a

month now, I feels that in the due course of time he'll be a shining light of the community, and maybe go to Congress."

"Good sentiments, Zeb," I agrees, "but it will likely be a close race between the voters and the sheriff to decide whether he goes to Helena or Deer Lodge."

"Haw! Haw! Haw!" roars Zeb. "Muley will never go to the penitentiary."

"Not willingly," I agrees. "What are your sheep worth today?"

"I have no sheep, Henry," he grins. "Sold out to a feller from St. Marie's basin, and his drive started today. Yep. I'm a civilian now."

"Got a good price, too," he grins, when he sees me look foolish-like at Muley. "Glad I sold. Too much sentiment against sheep. Well, boys, I reckon I'll toddle along. I couldn't sleep until I comes over and squares myself with Le-mule. Come over and make yourself to home at my place, Le-mule."

"Thanks, Zeb-uLeon," says Muley, "I may do that little thing, Zeb-uLeon. How's Susie, Zeb-uLeon?"

"Tolable, Le-mule. She's pining."

We watches him ride away, and then Muley spits, reflectively:

"Henry, if that old pelican had called me Le-mule once more I'd have slaughtered him. He must have found that letter I lost."

"You ought to invest your money in a detective agency, and run it yourself. I suppose you'll go over to see Susie?"

"Dang well know I will! Why not?"

"Go ahead. Go ahead, Muley, and lose a hundred thousand. What's a fortune beside her? Your brain ain't big enough, Muley. When it gets over forty dollars it all looks alike to you. You take my advice and buy sheep."

"Yah-h-h-h!" he blats. "Where?"

"What will you give me if I buy 'em for you?" I asks.

"You? You got a dead aunt, too, Henry?"

"No, but I got brains, and I can buy sheep."

"Go buy 'em then!" he snaps, "I'm from Missouri—me."

Muley rides away in the general direction of his heart's desire, and I gets an inspiration. Over in St. Marie's basin is plenty of sheep, and I never saw a sheep-man yet what wouldn't sell out. I like Muley. Dog-gone his irresponsible heart, I like him. His mind ain't big enough to contemplate a

hundred thousand dollars, and I feels glad for him that he's got a friend like me to make good for him.

I may be rewarded for my efforts, and maybe not, but anyway I've always wanted to handle big money, and show to the world that Henry Peck could be more than he's ever showed.

I saddles up Glory and puts a pack on Blazer, and leaves a note for Muley, telling him that I'll be back on the fatal day to save him from ruin. Little Henry is going to be a hero, and hopes to do his heroing on a commission basis.

I pilgrims over into a country that cowmen designates as being a fair example of the place where sinners will reside in the hereafter, and eats mutton and talks sheep.

Believe me I could talk sheep faster than the men that owned the herds, and I confides in 'em about Muley's inheritance. Of course I didn't tell it all, but anyway I got options on enough sheep to cause Yaller Rock County to build an extra wing on the insane asylum, and said options didn't cost me a cent.

"Old Testament" Tilton rides back with me. I've spent about fifteen thousand of Muley's credit with him, and being a minister, he's a little suspicious of his fellow-men.

"I ride with you for the good of my soul," orates the old boy, when he offers to accompany me.

I reckon that when a shepherd goes into cow-land, it's like taking a ship into fresh water to knock off the barnacles.

He's a queer old coot. Imagine a man of his cognomen, add the smell of sheep, dress him up around the neck like a preacher, tuck his pants into the top of a pair of heavy boots, and you've got a portrait of Old Testament. He rides a little calico bronc, with one cropped ear and a rat-tail, and calls it Ebenezer. The only way, I figure, that he could ever hand out salvation would be by correspondence.

"Now, this here Le-mule Bowles," remarks the old boy, "do you think I could induce him to come into the vineyard?"

"Muley will go into anything that's got a door on it," says I. "Also, he'll take anything what ain't nailed down."

"I fear me it will be a task," he says, sad-like, and then he sort of brightens up. "Have you ever considered your soul?"

“I have no soul,” says I.

“Say not that you are a lost sheep,” he chides me, and it makes me sore, and I points off down the valley.

“We’re in cow-land now, old-timer, so you lay off on that lost-sheep stuff. Sabe? Down here they calls ’em plain strays.”

We plods down into the Sleeping Creek country, and stops at Hank Padden’s place for dinner. Old Testament and Hank are old friends, but Hank don’t more than give me a nod. I reckon he ain’t forgot what he thought was Muley’s voice, and he blames me, too. When we gets ready to leave Hank acts like I had a contagious disease.

“Drop in any old time, Tilton,” says Hank. “Glad to see you.”

“Me, too, Hank?” I asks, and he gives me a hard look.

“You travels on your own responsibility,” he replies.

“I wonder what Hank is sore at me for?” I asks Old Testament, a little later, but he shakes his head, and mumbles something about the flocks on the seven hills and the wrath to come.

“Did you tell him that I bought them sheep?” I asks, and he nods.

“Yea. I did not lie, Henry Peck. I know naught of Bowles.”

“I suppose you also told him that I was going to stock this here range with sheep, didn’t you?”

“I merely told him that I surmised so.”

We rides almost to the Cross J, when we overtakes Abe Evans, the depot agent at Paradise.

“Gosh! I’m glad you caught me,” pants Abe, “I never was built to fit a saddle, and this here nag ain’t no rocking-chair. Here’s a telegram for Lemule Bowles, charges paid. You sign for it, Hen, and let me go back home.”

We pilgrims on to the ranch, but Muley ain’t there. There’s a note on the table which orates that he’ll be there at three o’clock, and it’s addressed to Weinie Lopp, of the Triangle.

“This here telegram ought to be opened,” opines Old Testament, who is as nosey as a pet coon. “A telegram always means that something is going to happen, and it’s better to be prepared.”

I tears the cover off and looks her over. It says—

Will arrive your town this date meet me with a vehicle.

And she’s signed Frederick & Quincy.

I look at my watch and decide on quick action.

"You set down here and rest your feet," says I to Old Testament, "I'll hitch up the buckboard, and go to town. I just got enough time to get there."

That was some ride. Them broncs were as wild as deer, and we went to Paradise so fast that the dust didn't settle for thirty minutes after I ties up at the station.

The train is late, so I goes over to Mike Pelly's place, and washes the sheep-taste out of my throat. It takes quite a lot of liquid, and when I goes back to the station I'm sheep-proof.

The train pulls in and I spots my man. There's quite a crowd at the station, but I knowed him the minute he got off, and it takes me about three steps to get where he's standing. Being sheep-proof, I'm also polite, so I takes his valise away from him, and starts for the rig.

"Come on, Blackstone," says I, "your carriage waits without."

He starts with me, but he seems to complain a heap, so I stops and asks him whyfore the objections.

"Where the Sam Hill are you taking my bag?" he asks, getting red in the face. "Who told you to take that valise?"

"Mister," says I, "don't excite yourself thataway. I'm doing all I can to make you comfortable. Sabe? I advises you to come along peaceable, and anything you may say will be used against you."

I always thought that lawyers tried to settle things peaceably, but I don't reckon this one runs true to form, 'cause he hit me so hard under the chin that he drove my head right up to the top of my hat. That hat always was too small, but after that wallop I has to stuff the sweat-band with paper so she'll fit.

The train is pulling out when I wakes up, and I sees that fat feller standing on the rear platform.

"What was you aiming to do, Hen?" asks Bill McFee, our sheriff, who is setting beside me on the platform.

"That was the feller I was here to meet, Bill," says I. "He's sure a sudden son-of-a-gun for a lawyer."

"He ain't no lawyer, Henry," says Bill. "He's the railroad paymaster, and he thought you was trying to steal his roll."

"Wrong man," says I. "Seen any stranger get off the train?"

Bill shakes his head, so I pilgrims around to where I tied my rig, and there sets Telescope, Chuck and the old man. Them three acts like they was tickled stiff, and Telescope yelps at me—

“Got the telegram, did you, Henry?”

I don’t have nothing to say, and that seems to make ’em more joyful. I don’t keep silent from choice, but that feller darn near unjointed my jaw and she hurts like thunder when I opens my face.

“Muley still wearing crape?” asks Chuck, as we ride out of town, and all three of ’em busts out laughing.

“Danged mean trick,” opines the old man. “You remember Jimmy Frederick, don’t you, Hen? He was out here a few years ago. He knows Muley well. We were up in his office and Telescope and Chuck got him to write that letter.”

“How many sheep has Muley bought on his nerve?” asks Chuck.

“Come on through, Hen. Did he buy out Zeb’s herd? I hope he ain’t got mutton for our supper.” And then Telescope sings sort of plaintive like;

“I love a little chicken and I love a little fish.
When somebody says ‘ham and eggs,’ I pass along my dish,
When I get good and hungry I could eat a roarin’ bull,
But when they passes mutton meat my stummick’s full.”

And then Chuck joins in the chorus:

“I’m a tough old rooster, and I’ve eaten snakes,
I’ve spread giant powder on my buckwheat cakes,
I’ve drank rawhide stew ’till I was out of breath,
But when they serves up mutton meat I starves to death.”

“You’re a fine bunch of friends!” I snaps, taking a chance that my jaw is still on its hinges. “She was his favorite relative, and since that letter he ain’t done nothing but mope. You’re a danged bunch of ghoulish comedians. Muley’s due to kill somebody when he finds out about it. What was the main idea?”

“Well,” laughs Telescope, “we made him rich for a while, didn’t we? Zeb orates that he wants Susie to marry money, so we gave it to him in a lump. We puts in that marriage clause just to see if Muley loved her enough to

lose the money, Sabe? We knowed danged well that he couldn't buy no sheep. What did the parrot have to say, Hen?"

"Told Hank Padden he could use sheep dip."

"Haw, haw, haw!" whoops Chuck. "Did he honest say that? I sat up all one night and day trying to teach that parrot some sheep-talk, but all it ever did was to bite me. Telescope swiped that cat at the depot in Milwaukee."

Just before we reaches the ranch, three people rides in ahead of us and waits for us to come up. It's Hank Padden, Johnny Myers and "Scenery" Sims. They all got rifles.

We exchanges greetings, but they don't seem glad to see nobody but me.

"We don't aim to be nosey, Mr. Peck," says Hank, "but we'd admire to hear a little more about them sheep."

"What sheep?" I asks, surprised-like.

"Old Testament told me," says Hank. "He spoke about you going to start a herd here and——"

"I thanks you for the compliment," says I. "It seems nice to be mistaken for a capitalist, Hank, but what I wants to know is this; how long since have you been taking the word of a shepherd? Do I need to deny it?"

"Old Testament must have lied, Hank," states the old man. "He must have been crazy to state such a thing. Somebody's crazy anyway."

"That's what I said," squeaks Scenery. "Hen Peck couldn't buy a pair of wool socks."

They all nods sort of agreeable-like, and he drives on.

"After a while, when there ain't nobody around to interrupt us, I'm going to ask you a few questions, Henry," states Chuck, solemn-like.

"You better bring a witness," says I. "All I wants is an uninterested third party present so I can prove I shot in self-defense."

We pulls up to the ranch. The front door is open and two rigs are tied out in front. We pilgrims up to the door, and are greeted with some sight.

There's Old Testament standing in the middle of the room, with his eyes rolled toward the rafters, while in front of him stands Susie Abernathy and Muley Bowles. Muley's vest is stretched to the bursting point, and you could light a match on Susie's freckles.

To one side stands Zeb Abernathy, and on the other stands Weinie Lopp, all dressed up in a celluloid collar, and no place to put his hands.

We hears Old Testament finish up his prayer, and as Muley folds Susie to his bosom we troops inside. Muley sees us over Susie's shoulder, and breaks the clinch. Zeb grins out through his whiskers and Weinie Lopp turns up the collar of his coat.

Everything is still for a few seconds, and then Old Testament smiles at me over his specs:

"My son," says he, "it's fortunate that I came with you. I had considered taking a trip over into the Bitter Roots, and Mister Lopp would have missed me."

"Exactly," says I, having the understanding of a fish. "All very true. Was Weinie on your trail?"

"Uh-huh," gurgles Weinie, "I—I was after a preacher for Muley."

"They—they just got married," chuckles Zeb. "Just now."

"Well," says Chuck, foolish-like, "who gets the first kiss from the bride—after you, Muley?"

"Muley, you're a hero!" gasps Telescope. "Any man is a hero who will sacrifice a hundred thousand dollars at the throne of love. Everybody take off your hats to Muley Bowles."

Everybody's got their hats off so we don't respond.

"What did you mean by that, Telescope?" gasps Zeb. "Do—do you mean that he—he'll lose all that money 'cause he married Susie?"

"You said it, Zeb," grins Telescope. "Ain't you proud of him? What a nephew-in-law!" and then he turns to Muley: "Muley, old-timer, I didn't think you had it in you, but you never can tell which way a dill pickle will squirt. How does it seem to lose a hundred thousand dollars?"

"Well," grins Muley, putting one arm around the shrinking bride. "I ain't lying to you when I says I don't know how it feels. You see, Telescope, the name of Allender don't cover no branch of my family-tree, and I never had any Aunt Agnes."

There's a painful silence for a minute, and then comes a flutter of feathers, and in waddles Alfred. He ain't got no tail-feathers left, and the rest of his carcass is pretty well plucked. He looks us over, wild-eyed, ruffles up his remaining foliage, croaks:

"Har, har, har! Who's crazy?"

Zeb looks wide-eyed at the bird for a moment, and then sneaks past it and out on the steps:

“I’m going away,” says he in a low, hoarse voice. “Going away before that bird answers its own questions.”

“Tally three more,” states Telescope, and him and Chuck and the old man sneaks out.

“Make it five,” says I, and me and Weinie goes out, too.

Transcriber’s Note: This story appeared in the September 3, 1918 issue of *Adventure* magazine.

*** END OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK MAKING GOOD
FOR MULEY ***

Updated editions will replace the previous one—the old editions will be renamed.

Creating the works from print editions not protected by U.S. copyright law means that no one owns a United States copyright in these works, so the Foundation (and you!) can copy and distribute it in the United States without permission and without paying copyright royalties. Special rules, set forth in the General Terms of Use part of this license, apply to copying and distributing Project Gutenberg™ electronic works to protect the PROJECT GUTENBERG™ concept and trademark. Project Gutenberg is a registered trademark, and may not be used if you charge for an eBook, except by following the terms of the trademark license, including paying royalties for use of the Project Gutenberg trademark. If you do not charge anything for copies of this eBook, complying with the trademark license is very easy. You may use this eBook for nearly any purpose such as creation of derivative works, reports, performances and research. Project Gutenberg eBooks may be modified and printed and given away—you may do practically ANYTHING in the United States with eBooks not protected by U.S. copyright law. Redistribution is subject to the trademark license, especially commercial redistribution.

START: FULL LICENSE

THE FULL PROJECT GUTENBERG™ LICENSE

PLEASE READ THIS BEFORE YOU DISTRIBUTE OR USE THIS WORK

To protect the Project Gutenberg™ mission of promoting the free distribution of electronic works, by using or distributing this work (or any other work associated in any way with the phrase “Project Gutenberg”), you agree to comply with all the terms of the Full Project Gutenberg License available with this file or online at www.gutenberg.org/license.

Section 1. General Terms of Use and Redistributing Project Gutenberg electronic works

1.A. By reading or using any part of this Project Gutenberg electronic work, you indicate that you have read, understand, agree to and accept all the terms of this license and intellectual property (trademark/copyright) agreement. If you do not agree to abide by all the terms of this agreement, you must cease using and return or destroy all copies of Project Gutenberg electronic works in your possession. If you paid a fee for obtaining a copy of or access to a Project Gutenberg electronic work and you do not agree to be bound by the terms of this agreement, you may obtain a refund from the person or entity to whom you paid the fee as set forth in paragraph 1.E.8.

1.B. “Project Gutenberg” is a registered trademark. It may only be used on or associated in any way with an electronic work by people who agree to be bound by the terms of this agreement. There are a few things that you can do with most Project Gutenberg electronic works even without complying with the full terms of this agreement. See paragraph 1.C below. There are a lot of things you can do with Project Gutenberg electronic works if you follow the terms of this agreement and help preserve free future access to Project Gutenberg electronic works. See paragraph 1.E below.

1.C. The Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation (“the Foundation” or PGLAF), owns a compilation copyright in the

collection of Project Gutenberg electronic works. Nearly all the individual works in the collection are in the public domain in the United States. If an individual work is unprotected by copyright law in the United States and you are located in the United States, we do not claim a right to prevent you from copying, distributing, performing, displaying or creating derivative works based on the work as long as all references to Project Gutenberg are removed. Of course, we hope that you will support the Project Gutenberg mission of promoting free access to electronic works by freely sharing Project Gutenberg works in compliance with the terms of this agreement for keeping the Project Gutenberg name associated with the work. You can easily comply with the terms of this agreement by keeping this work in the same format with its attached full Project Gutenberg License when you share it without charge with others.

1.D. The copyright laws of the place where you are located also govern what you can do with this work. Copyright laws in most countries are in a constant state of change. If you are outside the United States, check the laws of your country in addition to the terms of this agreement before downloading, copying, displaying, performing, distributing or creating derivative works based on this work or any other Project Gutenberg work. The Foundation makes no representations concerning the copyright status of any work in any country other than the United States.

1.E. Unless you have removed all references to Project Gutenberg:

1.E.1. The following sentence, with active links to, or other immediate access to, the full Project Gutenberg License must appear prominently whenever any copy of a Project Gutenberg work (any work on which the phrase “Project Gutenberg” appears, or with which the phrase “Project Gutenberg” is associated) is accessed, displayed, performed, viewed, copied or distributed:

This eBook is for the use of anyone anywhere in the United States and most other parts of the world at no cost and with almost no restrictions whatsoever. You may copy it, give it away or re-use it under the terms of the Project Gutenberg™ License included with

this eBook or online at www.gutenberg.org. If you are not located in the United States, you will have to check the laws of the country where you are located before using this eBook.

1.E.2. If an individual Project Gutenberg electronic work is derived from texts not protected by U.S. copyright law (does not contain a notice indicating that it is posted with permission of the copyright holder), the work can be copied and distributed to anyone in the United States without paying any fees or charges. If you are redistributing or providing access to a work with the phrase “Project Gutenberg” associated with or appearing on the work, you must comply either with the requirements of paragraphs 1.E.1 through 1.E.7 or obtain permission for the use of the work and the Project Gutenberg trademark as set forth in paragraphs 1.E.8 or 1.E.9.

1.E.3. If an individual Project Gutenberg electronic work is posted with the permission of the copyright holder, your use and distribution must comply with both paragraphs 1.E.1 through 1.E.7 and any additional terms imposed by the copyright holder. Additional terms will be linked to the Project Gutenberg License for all works posted with the permission of the copyright holder found at the beginning of this work.

1.E.4. Do not unlink or detach or remove the full Project Gutenberg License terms from this work, or any files containing a part of this work or any other work associated with Project Gutenberg.

1.E.5. Do not copy, display, perform, distribute or redistribute this electronic work, or any part of this electronic work, without prominently displaying the sentence set forth in paragraph 1.E.1 with active links or immediate access to the full terms of the Project Gutenberg License.

1.E.6. You may convert to and distribute this work in any binary, compressed, marked up, nonproprietary or proprietary form, including any word processing or hypertext form. However, if you provide access to or distribute copies of a Project Gutenberg work in a format other than “Plain Vanilla ASCII” or other format used in the official

version posted on the official Project Gutenberg website (www.gutenberg.org), you must, at no additional cost, fee or expense to the user, provide a copy, a means of exporting a copy, or a means of obtaining a copy upon request, of the work in its original “Plain Vanilla ASCII” or other form. Any alternate format must include the full Project Gutenberg License as specified in paragraph 1.E.1.

1.E.7. Do not charge a fee for access to, viewing, displaying, performing, copying or distributing any Project Gutenberg works unless you comply with paragraph 1.E.8 or 1.E.9.

1.E.8. You may charge a reasonable fee for copies of or providing access to or distributing Project Gutenberg electronic works provided that:

- You pay a royalty fee of 20% of the gross profits you derive from the use of Project Gutenberg works calculated using the method you already use to calculate your applicable taxes. The fee is owed to the owner of the Project Gutenberg trademark, but he has agreed to donate royalties under this paragraph to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation. Royalty payments must be paid within 60 days following each date on which you prepare (or are legally required to prepare) your periodic tax returns. Royalty payments should be clearly marked as such and sent to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation at the address specified in Section 4, “Information about donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation.”
- You provide a full refund of any money paid by a user who notifies you in writing (or by e-mail) within 30 days of receipt that s/he does not agree to the terms of the full Project Gutenberg™ License. You must require such a user to return or destroy all copies of the works possessed in a physical medium and discontinue all use of and all access to other copies of Project Gutenberg™ works.
- You provide, in accordance with paragraph 1.F.3, a full refund of any money paid for a work or a replacement copy, if a defect in the electronic work is discovered and reported to you within 90 days of receipt of the work.

- You comply with all other terms of this agreement for free distribution of Project Gutenberg™ works.

1.E.9. If you wish to charge a fee or distribute a Project Gutenberg™ electronic work or group of works on different terms than are set forth in this agreement, you must obtain permission in writing from the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, the manager of the Project Gutenberg™ trademark. Contact the Foundation as set forth in Section 3 below.

1.F.

1.F.1. Project Gutenberg volunteers and employees expend considerable effort to identify, do copyright research on, transcribe and proofread works not protected by U.S. copyright law in creating the Project Gutenberg™ collection. Despite these efforts, Project Gutenberg™ electronic works, and the medium on which they may be stored, may contain “Defects,” such as, but not limited to, incomplete, inaccurate or corrupt data, transcription errors, a copyright or other intellectual property infringement, a defective or damaged disk or other medium, a computer virus, or computer codes that damage or cannot be read by your equipment.

1.F.2. LIMITED WARRANTY, DISCLAIMER OF DAMAGES - Except for the “Right of Replacement or Refund” described in paragraph 1.F.3, the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, the owner of the Project Gutenberg™ trademark, and any other party distributing a Project Gutenberg™ electronic work under this agreement, disclaim all liability to you for damages, costs and expenses, including legal fees. YOU AGREE THAT YOU HAVE NO REMEDIES FOR NEGLIGENCE, STRICT LIABILITY, BREACH OF WARRANTY OR BREACH OF CONTRACT EXCEPT THOSE PROVIDED IN PARAGRAPH 1.F.3. YOU AGREE THAT THE FOUNDATION, THE TRADEMARK OWNER, AND ANY DISTRIBUTOR UNDER THIS AGREEMENT WILL NOT BE LIABLE TO YOU FOR ACTUAL, DIRECT, INDIRECT, CONSEQUENTIAL, PUNITIVE OR INCIDENTAL DAMAGES

EVEN IF YOU GIVE NOTICE OF THE POSSIBILITY OF SUCH DAMAGE.

1.F.3. LIMITED RIGHT OF REPLACEMENT OR REFUND - If you discover a defect in this electronic work within 90 days of receiving it, you can receive a refund of the money (if any) you paid for it by sending a written explanation to the person you received the work from. If you received the work on a physical medium, you must return the medium with your written explanation. The person or entity that provided you with the defective work may elect to provide a replacement copy in lieu of a refund. If you received the work electronically, the person or entity providing it to you may choose to give you a second opportunity to receive the work electronically in lieu of a refund. If the second copy is also defective, you may demand a refund in writing without further opportunities to fix the problem.

1.F.4. Except for the limited right of replacement or refund set forth in paragraph 1.F.3, this work is provided to you 'AS-IS', WITH NO OTHER WARRANTIES OF ANY KIND, EXPRESS OR IMPLIED, INCLUDING BUT NOT LIMITED TO WARRANTIES OF MERCHANTABILITY OR FITNESS FOR ANY PURPOSE.

1.F.5. Some states do not allow disclaimers of certain implied warranties or the exclusion or limitation of certain types of damages. If any disclaimer or limitation set forth in this agreement violates the law of the state applicable to this agreement, the agreement shall be interpreted to make the maximum disclaimer or limitation permitted by the applicable state law. The invalidity or unenforceability of any provision of this agreement shall not void the remaining provisions.

1.F.6. INDEMNITY - You agree to indemnify and hold the Foundation, the trademark owner, any agent or employee of the Foundation, anyone providing copies of Project Gutenberg™ electronic works in accordance with this agreement, and any volunteers associated with the production, promotion and distribution of Project Gutenberg™ electronic works, harmless from all liability, costs and expenses, including legal fees, that arise directly or indirectly from any of the following which you do or cause to occur: (a)

distribution of this or any Project Gutenberg work, (b) alteration, modification, or additions or deletions to any Project Gutenberg work, and (c) any Defect you cause.

Section 2. Information about the Mission of Project Gutenberg

Project Gutenberg is synonymous with the free distribution of electronic works in formats readable by the widest variety of computers including obsolete, old, middle-aged and new computers. It exists because of the efforts of hundreds of volunteers and donations from people in all walks of life.

Volunteers and financial support to provide volunteers with the assistance they need are critical to reaching Project Gutenberg's goals and ensuring that the Project Gutenberg collection will remain freely available for generations to come. In 2001, the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation was created to provide a secure and permanent future for Project Gutenberg and future generations. To learn more about the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation and how your efforts and donations can help, see Sections 3 and 4 and the Foundation information page at www.gutenberg.org.

Section 3. Information about the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation

The Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation is a non-profit 501(c)(3) educational corporation organized under the laws of the state of Mississippi and granted tax exempt status by the Internal Revenue Service. The Foundation's EIN or federal tax identification number is 64-6221541. Contributions to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation are tax deductible to the full extent permitted by U.S. federal laws and your state's laws.

The Foundation's business office is located at 41 Watchung Plaza #516, Montclair NJ 07042, USA, +1 (862) 621-9288. Email contact

links and up to date contact information can be found at the Foundation's website and official page at www.gutenberg.org/contact

Section 4. Information about Donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation

Project Gutenberg™ depends upon and cannot survive without widespread public support and donations to carry out its mission of increasing the number of public domain and licensed works that can be freely distributed in machine-readable form accessible by the widest array of equipment including outdated equipment. Many small donations (\$1 to \$5,000) are particularly important to maintaining tax exempt status with the IRS.

The Foundation is committed to complying with the laws regulating charities and charitable donations in all 50 states of the United States. Compliance requirements are not uniform and it takes a considerable effort, much paperwork and many fees to meet and keep up with these requirements. We do not solicit donations in locations where we have not received written confirmation of compliance. To SEND DONATIONS or determine the status of compliance for any particular state visit www.gutenberg.org/donate.

While we cannot and do not solicit contributions from states where we have not met the solicitation requirements, we know of no prohibition against accepting unsolicited donations from donors in such states who approach us with offers to donate.

International donations are gratefully accepted, but we cannot make any statements concerning tax treatment of donations received from outside the United States. U.S. laws alone swamp our small staff.

Please check the Project Gutenberg web pages for current donation methods and addresses. Donations are accepted in a number of other ways including checks, online payments and credit card donations. To donate, please visit: www.gutenberg.org/donate.

Section 5. General Information About Project Gutenberg electronic works

Professor Michael S. Hart was the originator of the Project Gutenberg concept of a library of electronic works that could be freely shared with anyone. For forty years, he produced and distributed Project Gutenberg eBooks with only a loose network of volunteer support.

Project Gutenberg eBooks are often created from several printed editions, all of which are confirmed as not protected by copyright in the U.S. unless a copyright notice is included. Thus, we do not necessarily keep eBooks in compliance with any particular paper edition.

Most people start at our website which has the main PG search facility: www.gutenberg.org.

This website includes information about Project Gutenberg, including how to make donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, how to help produce our new eBooks, and how to subscribe to our email newsletter to hear about new eBooks.